Metals Market Index MMI

MMi Dashboard

Iron Ore Price Indices

Iron Ore Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPI62 62% Fe Fines RMB/t

1021
7 0.69%
Mar 25th, 2022

Iron Ore Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPI65 65% Fe Fines RMB/t

1220
6.00 0.49%
Mar 25th, 2022

Iron Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPI58 58% Fe Fines RMB/t

844
2 0.24%
Mar 25th, 2022

Iron Ore Seaborne (CFR Qingdao)
IOSI62 62% Fe Fines USD/dmt

144.75
7.50 5.46%
Mar 25th, 2022

Iron Ore Seaborne (CFR Qingdao)
IOSI65 65% Fe Fines USD/dmt

173.30
5.50 3.28%
Mar 25th, 2022

Iron Ore Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPLI 62.5% Fe Lump RMB/t

1395
0 0.00%
Week Ending Mar 25th, 2022

Exchange Traded Contracts

DCE Iron Ore 62% Fines
I2201 (Jan) RMB/t (3pm close)

856.00
38.00 4.65%
Mar 25th, 2022 (3pm close)

SGX Iron Ore (CFR Qingdao) 62% Fe Fines
December 21 USD/dmt

153.40
5.80 3.93%
Mar 25th, 2022 (5.30 pm Print)

SHFE Rebar
RB2205 (Jan) RMB/t

5013
68 1.38%
Mar 25th, 2022 (3pm close)

Freight Rates

C3, Tubarao - Qingdao USD/t

26.69
0.08 0.30%
Mar 24th, 2022

C5, W. Australia - Qingdao USD/t

11.70
0.39 3.45%
Mar 24th, 2022

Steel Price

Steel Rebar (China Domestic) RMB/t

4980
30 0.61%
Week Ending Mar 25th, 2022

Inventory Levels

Iron Ore Inventory at Chinese Ports (35)
million tonnes

150.43
0.36 0.24%
Week Ending Mar 25th, 2022

Steel Inventory in China
million tonnes

20.16
0.00 0.01%
Week Ending Mar 25th, 2022

Steel Price

Steel HRC (China Domestic) RMB/t

5190
110 2.17%
Week Ending Mar 25th, 2022

IRON ORE PORT STOCK INDEX (IOPI)

Mar 25th, 2022		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne [1]						
Index	Fe Content	Price	Change	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]	Price	Change	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]
IOPI62	62% Fe Fines	1021	7	0.7%	1012	948	587	1680	149.98	0.95	0.6%	149.25	139.40	84.25	247.30
IOPI58	58% Fe Fines	844	2	0.2%	802	716	454	1421	124.60	0.22	0.2%	118.73	105.38	64.78	210.83
IOPI65	65% Fe Fines	1220	6	0.5%	1211	1144	843	1894	180.038	0.78	0.4%	179.52	169.05	122.83	278.61

IRON ORE SEABORNE INDEX (IOSI)

Mar 25th, 2022		CFR Qingdao, USD/dry tonne						
Index	Fe Content	Price	Change	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]
IOSI62	62% Fe Fines	144.75	7.50	5.46%	139.75	140.19	93.75	230.50
IOSI65	65% Fe Fines	173.30	5.50	3.28%	169.97	166.29	108.20	262.95

MARKET COMMENTARY

DCE iron ore futures market rose by 3.69%,the main contract closed 856, the quotation in the morning was increased by 10 yuan/mt over yesterday. and as the disk continues to rise, Traders' quotations are rising. But steel mills tended to be wait-and-see, and purchasing enthusiasm is not high. total transactions remained insipid. PBF at Shandong port dealt 965-970 yuan/mt; increased 15-20 yuan/mt over yesterday. SSF at Shandong port dealt 668-670 yuan/mt; increased 20 yuan/mt over yesterday. SSF at Caofeidian port dealt 680-685 yuan/mt; increased 10-15yuan/mt over yesterday. PBF at Tianjin port dealt 975 yuan/mt; increased 10 yuan/mt over yesterday. Stocks at 35 ports tracked by SMM totaled 150.43 million tons as of March 25, a slight accumulation of 360,000 tons from the previous week and 19.61 million tons from the same period last year. Meanwhile, the average daily port clearance volume of imported ore decreased by 75,000 tons to 2.531 million tons per week. Recently, due to the serious impact of the epidemic, the transportation of raw materials has been limited. Steel mills in Tangshan and other places chose to stop production of smokey furnace to cope with the epidemic, thus reducing the demand for iron ore. In addition, the ore purchased by steel mills in the early stage leads to the accumulation of port stocks due to the decrease of port thinning efficiency, especially in some northern ports. Considering the factors such as epidemic control and inventory of finished materials, steel mills are expected to improve the demand for raw materials is limited; While overseas mine transport volume is expected to pick up gradually, port inventory is expected to accumulate this week.

IRON ORE PORT LUMP INDEX (IOPLI)

Week Ending Mar 25th, 2022		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne [3]						
Index	Fe Content	Price	W-o-W	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]	Price	W-o-W	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]
IOPLI62	62.5% Fe Lump	1395	0	0.0%	1355	1186	730	1868	197.68	0.00	0.00%	191.90	167.58	101.31	262.13

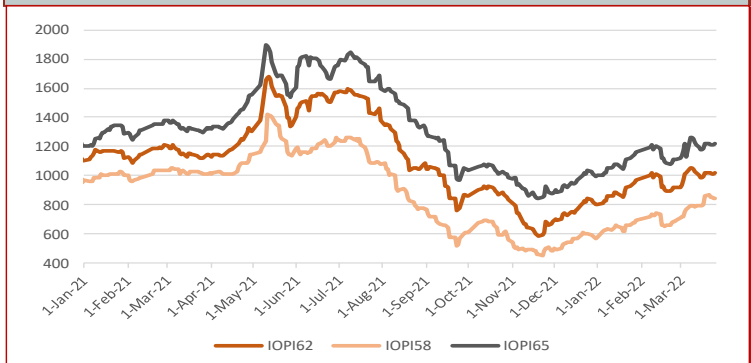
IRON ORE DOMESTIC CONCENTRATE SPOT PRICE ASSESSMENTS AND COMPOSITE INDEX

Week Ending Mar 25th, 2022				RMB/tonne (excluding tax) [3]				USD/tonne (excluding tax) [3]			
Province	Region	Product	Basis	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
Hebei	Hanxing	66% Fe Concentrate	Dry	1150	-7.0%	779	1645	180.66	-7.14%	110.31	1237.00
Hebei	Qian'an	65% Fe Concentrate	Dry	1090	-0.5%	780	1630	171.23	-0.58%	110.51	1125.00
Liaoning	Anshan	65% Fe Concentrate	Wet	1000	1.0%	620	1310	157.10	0.89%	87.40	1000.00
Shandong	Zibo	65% Fe Concentrate	Dry	1165	-7.5%	800	1752	183.02	-7.65%	122.55	1260.00

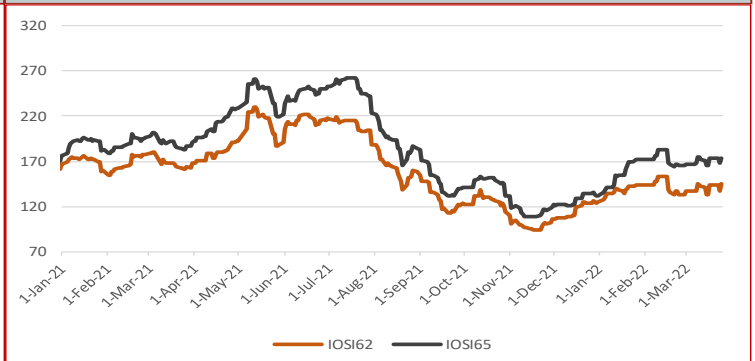
Week Ending Mar 25th, 2022	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
China Mines Concentrate Composite Index RMB/WT	1034.02	-3.05%	706.36	1511.22

[1] Exchange rate applied: RMB/USD = 6.4934 [2] Last 12 months
[3] Weekly exchange rate applied: RMB/USD 6.5044

IRON ORE PORT INDEX, FOT QINGDAO (RMB/WT)



IRON ORE SEABORNE INDEX, CFR QINGDAO (USD/DMT)



IRON ORE PORT STOCK INDEX MONTHLY, QUARTERLY AND YEAR-TO-DATE AVERAGES

Mar 25th, 2022		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne						
Index	Fe Content	November	December	January	February	MTD	QTD	YTD	November	December	January	February	MTD	QTD	YTD
IOPI62	62% Fe Fines	694	770	886	946	1012	948	948	100.58	112.01	129.82	139.07	149.25	139.40	139.40
IOPI58	58% Fe Fines	500	560	646	696	802	716	716	72.07	81.21	94.58	102.36	118.73	105.38	105.38
IOPI65	65% Fe Fines	888	962	1079	1139	1211	1144	1144	129.88	141.30	159.15	168.36	179.52	169.05	169.05

IRON ORE SEABORNE INDEX MONTHLY, QUARTERLY AND YEAR-TO-DATE AVERAGES

Mar 25th, 2022		CFR Qingdao, USD/dry tonne						
Index	Fe Content	November	December	January	February	MTD	QTD	YTD
IOSI62	62% Fe Fines	99.03	115.86	137.61	142.80	139.75	140.19	140.19
IOSI65	65% Fe Fines	114.32	127.26	155.72	172.28	169.97	166.29	166.29

FREIGHT RATES

Mar 24th, 2022		FREIGHT RATES - DRY BULK US$/wet tonne				
Route	Designation		Change	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
W. Australia - Qingdao	C5	11.70	0.39	3.45%	3.57	16.77
Tubarao - Qingdao	C3	26.69	0.08	0.30%	6.70	36.40

IRON ORE PORT LUMP INDEX MONTHLY, QUARTERLY AND YEAR-TO-DATE AVERAGES

Week Ending Mar 25th, 2022		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne [1]						
Index	Fe Content	November	December	January	February	MTD	QTD	YTD	November	December	January	February	MTD	QTD	YTD
IOPLI62	62.5% Fe Lump	800	877	1049	1145	1355	1186	1186	196.49	147.90	147.80	161.53	191.90	167.58	167.58

IRON ORE INDEX PREMIUMS/DISCOUNTS

Mar 25th, 2022		PORT STOCK INDEX (RMB/WT)	
Index	Fe Content	Spread to IOPI62	% Spread to IOPI62
IOPI58	58% Fe Fines	-177	-17.34%
IOPI65	65% Fe Fines	199	19.49%

Mar 25th, 2022		SEABORNE INDEX (USD/DMT)	
Index	Fe Content	Spread to IOSI62	% Spread to IOSI62
IOSI65	65% Fe Fines	28.55	19.72%

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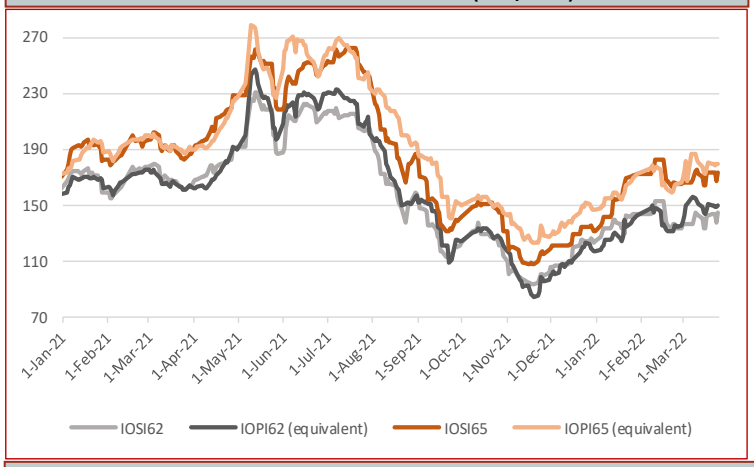
IRON ORE INDEX COMPARISONS (USD/DMT)



CHINA DOMESTIC COMPOSITE MINES INDEX (RMB/Wet Tonne, including VAT)

IRON ORE BRAND SPOT PRICE ASSESMENTS

Mar 25th, 2022	PORT STOCK INDEX (RMB/WT)		
	Price	Change	Diff to IOPI62
Roy Hill	960	7	-61
SIMEC Fines	897	8	-124
PB Fines	987	7	-34
Newman Fines	1008	7	-13
MAC Fines	964	7	-57
Jimblebar Blended Fines	884	7	-137
Carajas Fines	1200	7	179
Brazilian SSF	988	7	-33
Brazilian Blend Fines	998	7	-23
RTX Fines	905	7	-116
West Pilbara Fines	931	7	-90

Mar 25th, 2022	SEABORNE INDEX (USD/DMT)		
	Price	Change	Diff to IOSI62
Roy Hill	140.25	7.50	-4.50
SIMEC Fines	136.75	7.50	-8.00
PB Fines	141.00	7.50	-3.75
Newman Fines	143.90	7.50	-0.85
MAC Fines	141.00	7.50	-3.75
Jimblebar Blended Fines	133.40	7.50	-11.35
Carajas Fines	174.30	7.50	29.55
Brazilian SSF	148.50	7.50	3.75
Brazilian Blend Fines	150.15	7.50	5.40
RTX Fines	134.65	7.50	-10.10
West Pilbara Fines	139.00	7.50	-5.75

Mar 25th, 2022	PORT STOCK INDEX (RMB/WT)		
	Price	Change	Diff to IOPI58
SSF	844	2	0
FMG Blended Fines	853	2	9
Robe River	849	2	5
Western Fines	858	1	14
Atlas Fines	852	2	8
Yandi	837	2	-7

IRON ORE INDEX NORMALISATION DIFFERENTIALS

Port Stock Index Product Differentials (RMB/wet tonne)

	Applicable range	Value	Change
1% Fe	High Grade Fe 60 - 63%	66.00	-1.00
	High Grade Fe 63 - 64%	58.00	0.00
	High Grade Fe 64 - 65%	58.00	0.00
	High Grade Fe 65 - 65.5%	58.00	0.00
	Low Grade Fe	100.00	0.00
1% Alumina	High Fe Grade Al <2.25%	5.00	0.00
	High Fe Grade Al 2.25-4%	69.00	0.00
	Low Fe Grade Al <2.25%	100.00	0.00
	Low Fe Grade Al 2.25-4%	33.00	-5.00
1% Silica	High Fe Grade Si <4%	5.00	0.00
	High Fe Grade Si 4-6.5%	23.00	-2.00
	Low Fe Grade	16.00	1.00
0.01% Phosphorus	High Fe Grade 0.09%<P<0.115%	12.00	0.00
	High Fe Grade 0.115%<P<0.15%	12.00	0.00
	Low Fe Grade 0.09<P<0.1%	13.00	-2.00

Seaborne Index Product Differentials (USD/dry tonne)

	Applicable range	Value	Change
1% Fe	High Grade Fe 60 - 63%	4.75	0.25
	High Grade Fe 63 - 64%	1.25	0.00
	High Grade Fe 64 - 65%	1.25	0.00
	High Grade Fe 65 - 65.5%	1.25	0.00
1% Alumina	High Fe Grade Al <2.25%	7.25	0.00
	High Fe Grade Al 2.25-4%	3.25	0.25
1% Silica	High Fe Grade Si <4%	6.25	0.00
	High Fe Grade Si 4 - 6.5%	4.25	-0.25
0.01% Phosphorus	High Fe Grade 0.09%<P<0.115%	2.00	0.00
	High Fe Grade 0.115%<P<0.15%	1.75	0.25

Port Stock Price Differentials to Qingdao Port for PB Fines (RMB/wet tonne)

Port	Value	Change	Port	Value	Change	Port	Value	Change	Port	Value	Change
Bayuquan	-100.00	0.00	Fangcheng	-25.00	0.00	Lanshan	0.00	0.00	Rizhao	0.00	0.00
Beilun	0.00	0.00	Jiangyin	-30.00	0.00	Lianyungang	0.00	0.00	Shekou	0.00	0.00
Caofeidian	-20.00	0.00	Jingtang	-20.00	0.00	Majishan	0.00	0.00	Taicang	-25.00	0.00
Dalian	0.00	0.00	Lanqiao	0.00	0.00	Qingdao	0.00	0.00	Tianjin	-30.00	0.00

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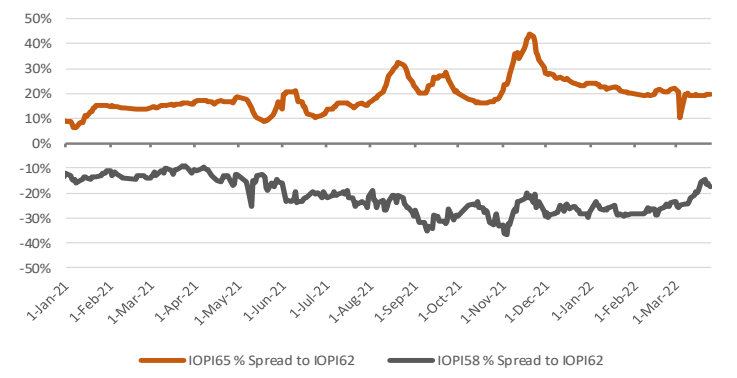
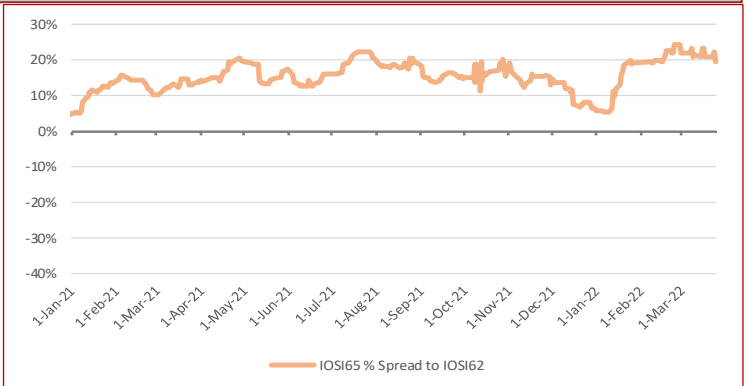
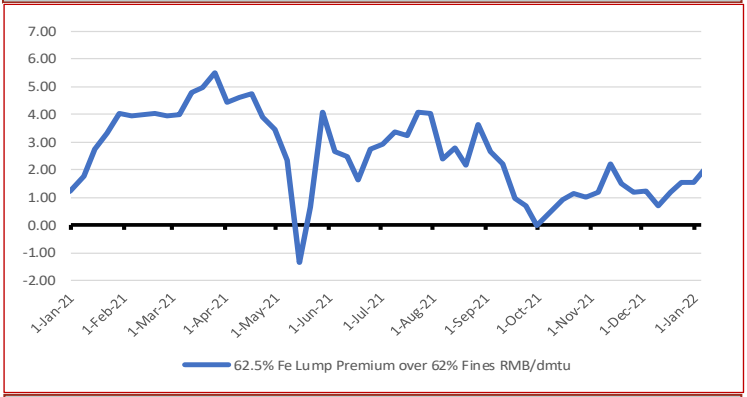
IRON ORE INDEX PREMIUMS/DISCOUNTS

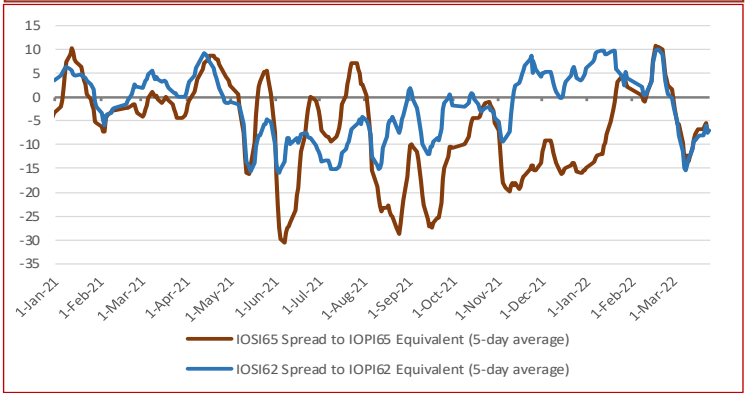




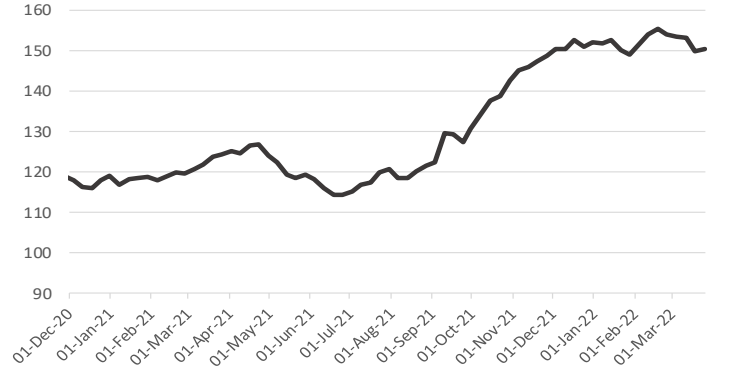
WEEKLY IRON ORE PORT STOCK LUMP PREMIUM (RMB/DMTU)



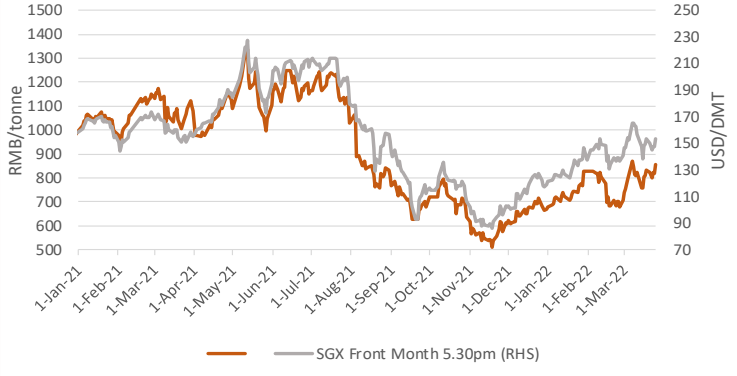
IRON ORE SEABORNE TO PORT STOCK PRICE SPREADS (USD/DMT)



TOTAL IRON ORE INVENTORIES AT CHINA PORTS (MILLION TONNES)



FUTURE TRADING—FRONT MONTH CLOSING PRICE



IRON ORE PORT INVENTORIES (MILLION TONNES)

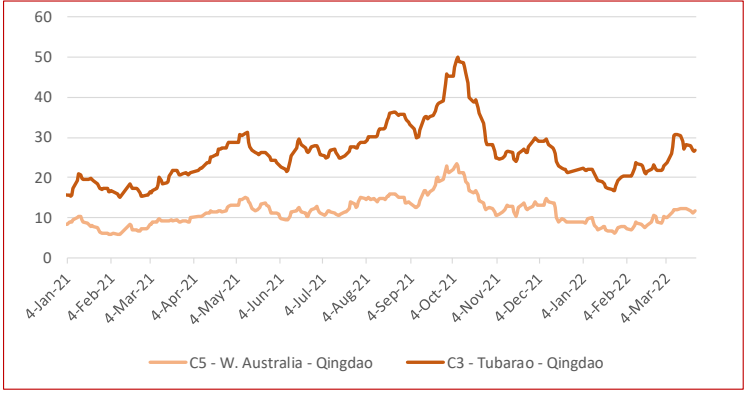
Week Ending Mar 25th, 2022

Province	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
Jingtang	16.67	9.74%	12.26	19.20
Qingdao	26.24	1.94%	9.41	26.24
Caofeidian	14.73	1.94%	11.25	16.25
Tianjin	10.78	-3.58%	7.14	12.97
Rizhao	17.60	-0.23%	9.44	19.26
Total (35 Ports)	150.43	0.24%	98.80	155.39

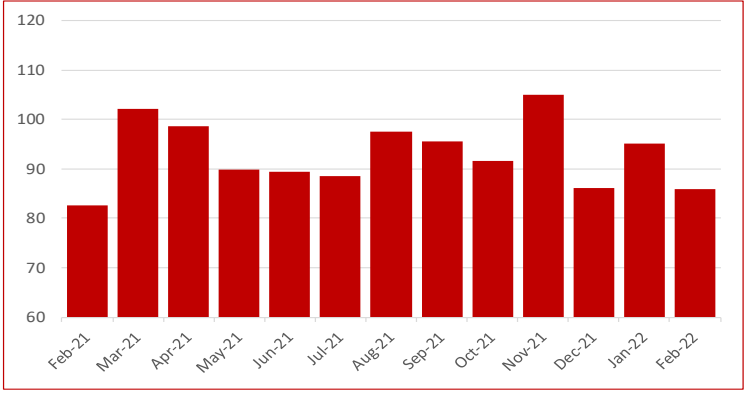
IRON ORE FUTURES CONTRACTS

	DCE (RMB/WMT)			SGX (USD/DMT)		
Closing Date	Mar 25th, 3pm close			Mar 25th, 5:30pm		
Contract	I2205	Change	Change %	Nov. 21	Change	Change %
Closing Price	856.00	38.00	4.65%	153.40	5.80	3.93%
Vol traded ('000 lots)	35.81	1.27	3.69%	1.99	-0.65	-24.58%
Open positions ('000 lots)	39.64	-1.06	-2.61%	18.76	-0.25	-1.30%
Day Low	823.0	10.50	1.29%	147.40	0.30	0.20%
Day High	858.0	23.50	2.82%	153.60	3.60	2.40%

DRY BULK FREIGHT RATES (USD/MT)



TOTAL CHINA IRON ORE IMPORT VOLUMES (MILLION TONNES)



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STEEL SPOT MARKET PRICES—CHINA

Steel Spot Market RMB/tonne

Product	2022/3/25	Change	Change %
ReBar HRB400 ϕ18mm	4,980	30	0.61%
Wirerod Q300 ϕ6.5mm	5,150	30	0.59%
HRC Q235/SS400 5.5mm*1500*C	5,190	110	2.17%
CRC SPCC/ST12 1.0mm*1250*2500	5,610	10	0.18%
Medium & Heavy Plate Q235B 20mm	5,150	50	0.98%
GI ST02Z 1.0mm*1000*C	5,890	50	0.86%
Colour Coated Plate	8,200	-100	-1.20%

CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY

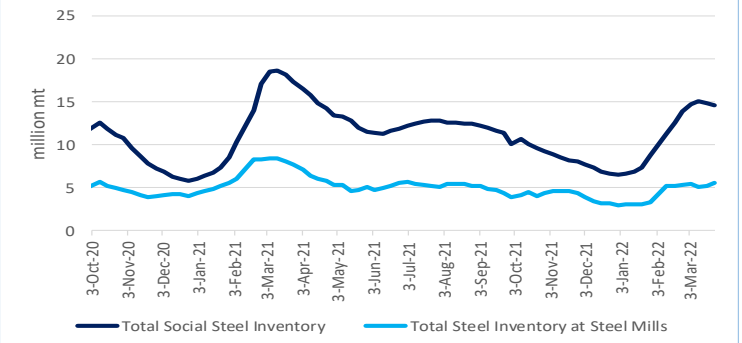
SMM Tracking of Steel Mill P&L - Rebar and Hot-rolled Coil (RMB/tonne)

Category	Price	Change (WoW)	Note
MMi (Fe 62%), USD/mt exluding tax	137.25	-6	Mmi CFR Equivalent index for 1st Feb
Coke	3,820	0	2nd grade met coke, Tangshan, incl. tax
Steel Scrap	3,870	100	steel scrap (6mm) in Zhangjiagang, exl. tax
Billet Cost	4,390	39	Q234, incl. tax
Rebar cost - Blast furnace	4,994	44	calculated based on theoretical weight, incl. tax
Rebar profit - Blast furnace	-74	-24	based on Shanghai prices, incl. tax
Hot-rolled coil cost - Blast furnace	4,912	41	based on actual weight, incl. tax
Hot-rolled coil proft - Blast furnace	278	69	based on Shanghai prices, incl. tax

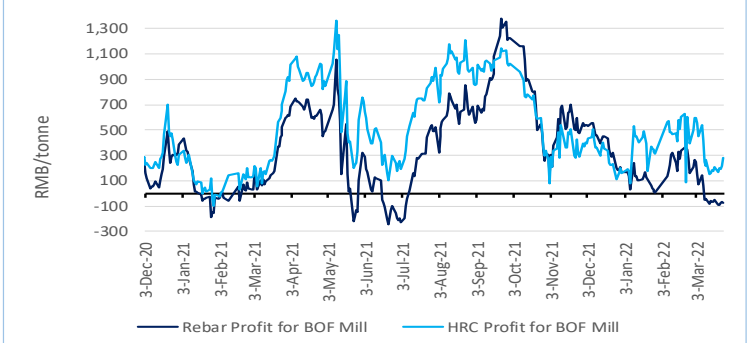
Note: 1. Costs in the table are caluclated based on todays market prices and facout our management, sales, financial and depreciations fe

2. The cost refers to average cost in the industry based on SMM's survey of small, medium and large mills in China

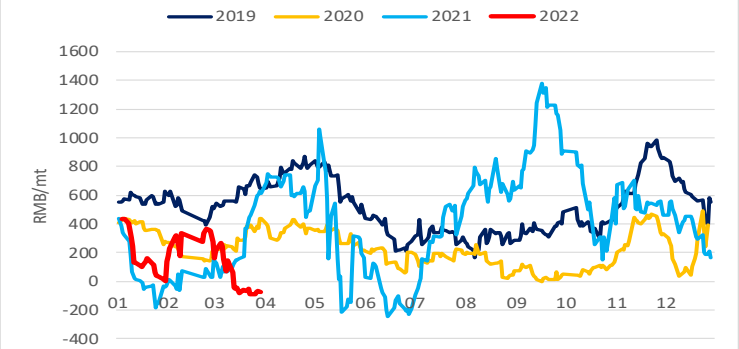
CHINESE STEEL INVENTORIES



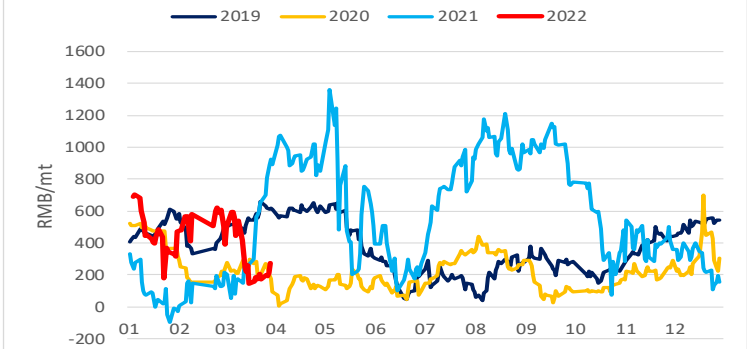
CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY



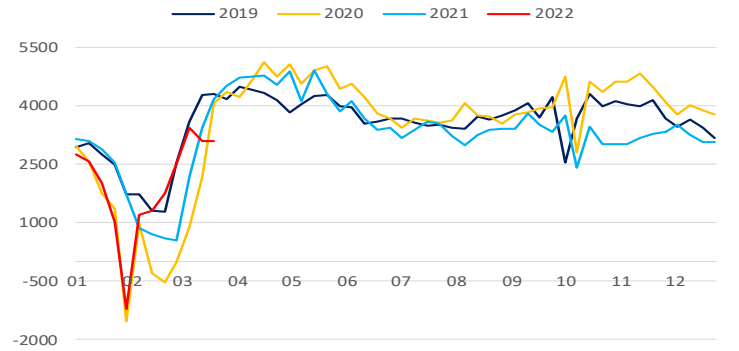
CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY—Rebar



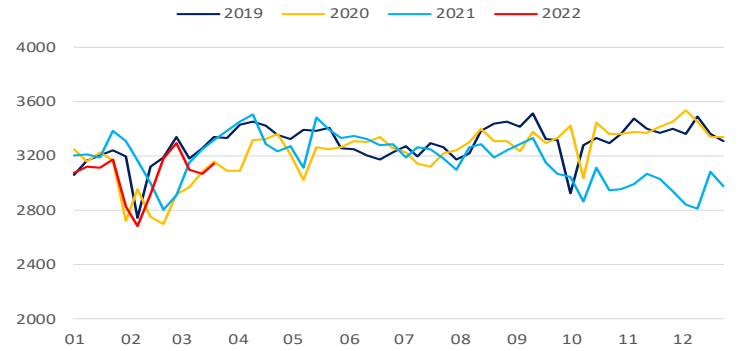
CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY—Hot-rolled Coil



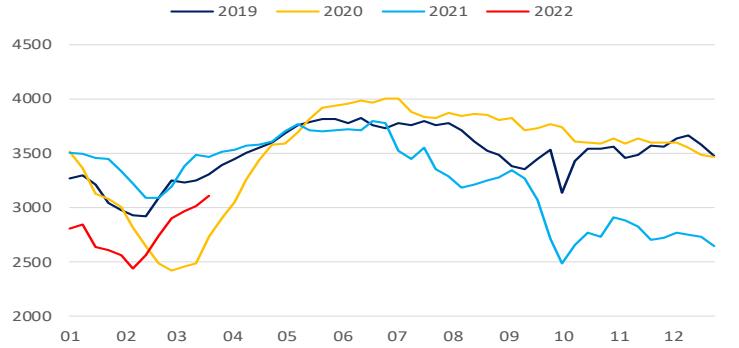
CHINESE STEEL CONSUMPTION—Rebar



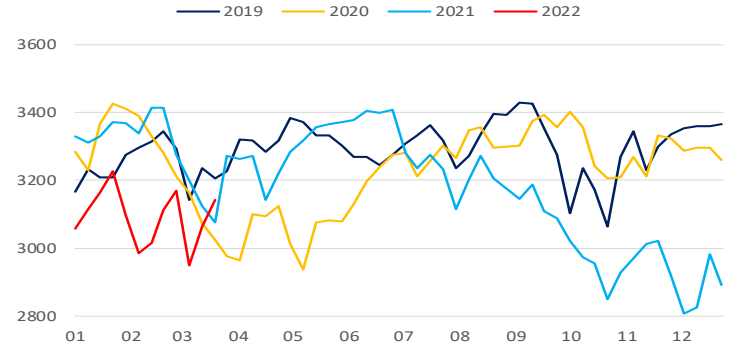
CHINESE STEEL CONSUMPTION—Hot-rolled Coil



CHINESE STEEL PRODUCTION—Rebar



CHINESE STEEL PRODUCTION—Hot-rolled Coil



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IRON ORE INDEX SPECIFICATIONS, COMPILATION RATIONALE AND DATA EXCLUSIONS

Iron Ore Index Specifications (Port and Seaborne)

	65% Fe Fines	62% Fe Fines	58% Fe Fines	62.5% Fe Lump
Fe %	65.00	62.00	58.00	62.50
Alumina %	1.40	2.25	2.25	1.50
Silica%	1.50	4.00	5.50	3.50
Phosphorus %	0.06	0.09	0.05	0.08
Sulphur %	0.01	0.02	0.02	0.02
Moisture %	8.00	8.00	9.00	4.00
Sizing	Granular size below 10mm for at least 90% of cargo; maximum of 40% below 150 micron			Size below 6.3mm max 15% Size above 31.15mm max 25%
Pricing Point	Qingdao Port (FOT and CFR respectively)			FOT Qingdao Port
Timing (Seaborne)	Loading within 4 weeks, Delivery within 8 weeks			Delivery within 2 weeks
Payment Terms	L/C at sight			L/C at sight or CAD

Iron Ore Index Compilation Rationale and Data Exclusions

MMi iron ore indices are compiled from data provided by companies that are part of the iron ore supply chain and involved in spot market transactions. The indices are calculated using detailed transaction-level data submitted to MMi by these companies. This data is normalised to the appropriate specifications and screened to remove outliers before volume-weighted average prices are calculated from the remaining core set of data.

For more details on MMi's iron ore methodology please download the guide published on our website at: www.mmiprices.com

Data Exclusions*

	62%	58%	65%
Port Index	0	0	0
Seaborne index	0		0
Lump Index 62.5	0		

* Number of price submissions for iron ore indices that were excluded from index calculations today as they were anomalous and could not be verified

IRON ORE DOMESTIC CONCENTRATE INDEX CALCULATION METHODOLOGY

The compilation method for price index generally refers to the compilation method of CPI price index and other price indices, breakdown the price data and calculate the average value according to a certain method, taking the vertical axis as the regional composite index (average of different grade index) and the horizontal axis as the grade composite index (average of different regional index), a total composite index for domestic ore can be output ultimately. The process system is also adopted in the calculation i.e. each sub-index can be obtained as well.

AVERAGE IRON ORE SPECIFICATIONS APPLIED FOR BRAND PRICE ASSESSMENTS

PORT STOCK BRANDS

Mar 25th, 2022	Specifications applied for 62% brand assessments				
	Fe	Alumina	Silica	Phos	Moisture
Roy Hill	60.88%	2.35%	4.45%	0.055%	9.26%
SIMEC Fines	60.00%	2.30%	6.30%	0.060%	6.00%
PB Fines	61.64%	2.31%	3.87%	0.099%	9.45%
Newman Fines	62.49%	2.31%	3.98%	0.090%	7.72%
MAC Fines	60.43%	2.38%	4.64%	0.078%	7.57%
Jimblebar Blended Fines	60.87%	2.95%	4.53%	0.111%	7.32%
Carajas Fines	64.90%	1.39%	1.82%	0.080%	7.78%
Brazilian SSF	62.00%	1.00%	6.50%	0.040%	6.00%
Brazilian Blend Fines	62.56%	1.58%	4.79%	0.091%	8.72%
RTX Fines	61.00%	3.10%	4.50%	0.135%	7.50%
West Pilbara Fines	60.10%	2.30%	4.70%	0.075%	8.50%

Mar 25th, 2022	Specifications applied for 58% brand assessments				
	Fe	Alumina	Silica	Phos	Moisture
SSF	56.49%	3.20%	6.19%	0.065%	9.18%
FMG Blended Fines	58.20%	2.43%	5.54%	0.057%	8.29%
Robe River	56.44%	3.16%	5.73%	0.042%	8.44%
Western Fines	57.88%	2.87%	7.50%	0.062%	7.45%
Atlas Fines	58.00%	1.85%	5.50%	0.090%	9.00%
Yandi	56.87%	1.58%	6.41%	0.042%	9.53%

SEABORNE BRANDS

	Specifications applied for 62% brand assessments				
	Fe	Alumina	Silica	Phos	Moisture
Roy Hill	60.70%	2.30%	4.90%	0.055%	8.00%
SIMEC Fines	60.00%	2.30%	6.30%	0.060%	6.00%
PB Fines 62%	62.00%	2.60%	4.30%	0.090%	9.50%
Newman Fines	62.30%	2.40%	4.30%	0.095%	8.00%
MAC Fines	60.80%	2.35%	4.40%	0.075%	7.80%
Jimblebar Blended Fines	60.50%	3.10%	4.80%	0.120%	7.80%
Carajas Fines	65.10%	1.50%	1.70%	0.080%	8.50%
Brazilian SSF	62.00%	1.00%	6.50%	0.040%	6.00%
Brazilian Blend Fines	63.00%	1.50%	5.00%	0.070%	7.00%
RTX Fines	61.00%	3.10%	4.50%	0.135%	7.50%
West Pilbara Fines	60.10%	2.30%	4.70%	0.075%	8.50%

BLOOMBERG TICKERS

PORT STOCK INDICES

	FOT Qingdao (RMB/wet tonne)	CFR Qingdao Equivalent (USD/dry tonne)
IOPI62	IRCNQ001	IRCNQ004
IOPI58	IRCNQ002	IRCNQ005
IOPI65	IRCNQ003	IRCNQ006
IOPLI62	IRCN0036	IRCN0037

SEABORNE INDICES

	CFR Qingdao (USD/DMT)
IOSI62	IRCN0034
IOSI65	IRCN0035

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